  

Principal - Tara Goudy	**Teacher Representatives -** Sarah Van Kruistum, Betsy Pawson

Co-Chairs - Caroline Hissa & Caitlin Wood	**Treasurer** - TBD	**Secretary** - Emily Bell

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2026/2027
Sheppard Public School School Council Meeting
Minutes - Monday, September 21, 6:00pm

Meeting will be held in person in the library

Attendance:
Lindsay Rooke, Mardi Bergen, Caitlin Wood, Laura Stephens, Julie Mainland, Emily Bell, Teneile Warren, Bethany Wagler-Mantle, Sarah Van Kruistum, Sarah Yardley, Betsy Pawson, Bernice Pengelly, Caroline Hissa, Caitlin Pearson, Kristin Poon

Agenda	Minutes
Welcome and snacks Welcome & introductions	**Snacks next time All introduced themselves and how they are connected to Sheppard
Group Norms	- All signed group norms - Highlights: - • Keep our shared goal at the centre: the academic and personal growth of every Sheppard student. - • Protect the privacy of students, families, and staff; do not discuss individual cases.
Elections	- Reviewed the role of council as an advisory body - Co-Chairs voted in - **Caroline Hissa & Caitlin Wood** - Secretary voted in - **Emily Bell** - Treasurer - **TBD**

Principal's Update	**1. Welcome & Start-of-Year Overview** ● **Calm Start:** Share how smoothly the school year has kicked off and express gratitude to the staff, students, and community for a warm welcome. ● **Enrolment & Class Organization:** ○ Update on current enrolment numbers and late-summer registration trends. - we have ■ 396 students, down from 400 at the end of June. ○ Class sizes and capacity across Kindergarten, Primary/Junior, and Intermediate levels. ■ Kindergarten - nice sized classes ■ Primary - on point with 20 or below. ■ Junior getting higher, 5/6A having 28, 4/5 A with 25 etc **2. Academics & Curriculum Focus** ● **Literacy Initiatives:** ○ Status of early reading assessments (Oral Reading Fluency and Acadience literacy testing). ● **School Improvement Goals:** ○ Ongoing commitment to core focus areas: Literacy, Inclusivity, and Neurodiversity. (Tier 2 Literacy focus) ○ Professional learning goals created by teachers to drive student learning and well-being. **3. Student Well-being & School Culture** ● **Staff board -** Group of staff worked to de-center the staff board to the other wall and center the student creations as people enter the school. Initiative of group learning in a project - Dismantling Anti-Black Racism. ● **Bullying Prevention & Community Safety:** ○ Awareness around reporting resources, including the online Bullying Prevention & Intervention reporting tool. - found on the website ○ Ongoing commitment to student safety, vigilance, and proactive support across all staff members. **4. Facilities, Infrastructure & Transportation** ● **Elevator in the works -** looking at Summer 2027 for construction to start ● **flooding concerns being addressed -** (new sump pumps) and long term solutions happening at the same time as the Elevator construction project ● **Investigating with facilities on adding more Air Conditioning to more classrooms** ● **Overall school is well kept** **5. Athletics, Clubs & Community Involvement** ● **School Events:** Meet the Educator night success, Terry Fox Kick off assembly success, welcome assembly, ○ Feedback on Meet the Educator - more signage and explanation of what to expect ○ Support with making the activities in each class more cohesive across the school

	○ Side bar - for School Council - more explanation of what the role of school council is and what to expect when inviting people to attend School Council ● **Athletics & Leadership:** Soccer intramurals, announcement club ● **Clubs & Extracurriculars:** ○ Still getting things up and running for students
Teacher Update	No questions for the teachers at this time
Chocolate Bar Fundraiser **Goals for Fundraiser**	- Formed a subcommittee to support the fundraiser - Brief overview of the fundraiser - Discussion for what the fundraiser is for - School trips & class activities
Initiatives for 2026/2027 school year	- Clothing Swap - Approved - Julie Mainland - Aiming for beginning of November - Maker's Market - Approved - Subcommittee formed: Tiffany Winton, Lindsay Rooke, and Kristin Poon - Pushing for before winter break - Parent event - TBD
Financial Report	- $17,000 in the School Council account - Approved for purchase: - $5000 for one bus per homeroom - $1000 for classroom, reusable mops and extra pads
Future Date	Thursday June 10, 2027 approved for FUN FAIR

Future meeting dates:

- Monday, November 23, 2026
- Monday, February 23, 2027
- Monday, April 20, 2027

School Council Roles:

- **CHAIRPERSON (CO-CHAIRS)**: In addition to performing the duties of a Council member, the chair:
  - Calls Council meetings;
  - Prepares the agenda for Council meetings with the principal;
  - Chairs Council meetings;
  - Ensures that minutes of Council meetings are recorded and maintained;
  - Communicates with the school principal;
  - Ensures that there is regular communication with the school community;
  - Consults with senior staff members of the school board and trustees as required;
  - Organizes future elections with the principal;
  - Facilitates the resolution of conflict;
  - Participates as an ex-officio member of all committees established by the School Council;
  - Monitors Treasurer's reports for School Council funds;
  - Completes the Annual Report as required;
  - Attends Waterloo Region Assembly of Public School (WRAPSC) meetings as able or designates an alternate
- **SECRETARY:** In addition to performing the duties of a Council member, the Secretary:
  - Ensures that minutes of Council meetings are recorded and maintained;
  - Keeps a record of all proceedings of the Council during the current school year;
  - Gives notice of all meetings and keeps a file of all records and documents;
  - Attends to all correspondence and communications, including ensuring accurate representation on the school website
- **TREASURER**: In addition to performing the duties of a Council member, the Treasurer:
  - Prepares a budget for the school year, including projected fundraising revenue and a disbursement plan;
  - Reviews and authorizes the deposits and expenditures for School Council activities;
  - Coordinates the deposits and expenditures with the Secretary or Principal of the School and the School Council members;
  - Obtains from the Principal or School Secretary any additional updated financial information or the Council each month;
  - Reconciles the Council spreadsheet from the School with the documentation from the Council members;
  - Presents a statement of the accounts at every meeting;
- **GENERAL EXPECTATIONS OF COUNCIL MEMBERS**
  - It is the duty of a parent/guardian member to attend 70% of the regularly scheduled meetings of the School Council to maintain voting privileges, from the time elected or joined.
  - Additional responsibilities of each parent/guardian member are to:
    - Participate in discussions at meetings;
    - Attend School Council events;
    - Work cooperatively to develop common goals at the Board and school level;
    - Serve as an advocate and voice for the members of the school community and maintain confidentiality;
    - Volunteer to assist with Council activities.